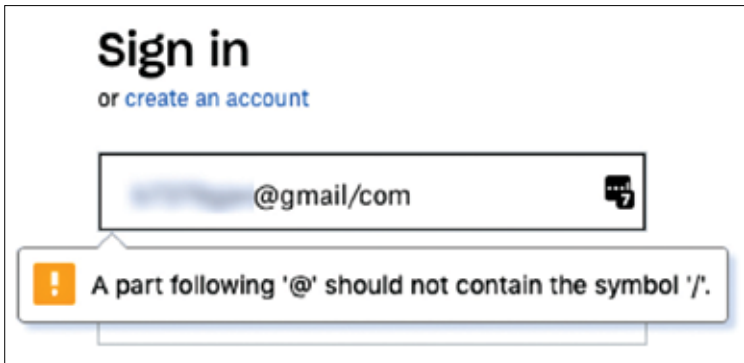




- **Frequent updates and patches** – Make sure you apply patches and updates frequently on your system (mainly the SQL database) and remain on the latest version as much as you can.
- **Limit the access privileges** – Never connect to your database with an account having administrator level access (root access) unless required. Make use of an account with lesser access privileges so that it does not give the hacker much to do within your system and reduce the scope of the damage if any.
- **Disable shell access completely.** This functionality becomes very easy for hackers to take control of your system.
- **Ensure the safety of credentials** – Make sure that your application and database passwords and other confidential data are encrypted and secure.

2. Cross-Site Scripting (XSS)

As discussed in the previous chapter, XSS is one of the most dangerous and frequently used hacking techniques to detect vulnerabilities in web applications. Hackers make use of this technique to retrieve the stored cookies that contain vital information, inject malicious malware into the web application, hijack a session and more. To protect from XSS attacks, website owners should ensure the following:

- Ensure that you never put any untrusted data directly within these tags - `<script>`, `<! ... -- >`, `<div ..... />`, `<style ..... /style>`.
- However, if need may be that you have to insert untrusted data into the HTML body, make sure you follow the “Escaping” tech-